



KAEDEN'S PRODUCTION SYSTEM · CHEAT SHEET EDITION

THE FAST **VERSION.** EVERYTHING THAT ACTUALLY MATTERS.

Every framework, system, and edit trick from your three Production Bibles — boiled down to the parts you'll actually use. Zero fluff, zero backstory needed. Built to get you from "I have an idea" to "it's live" without reading 127 pages first.

Distilled from: The YouTube Production Bible · Bible 2.0: The System · The VanossMethod

Built for: Kaeden's channel — Roblox, horror, simulators, Fortnite, Apex & co-op chaos with Bill

Verified against: July 2026 YouTube algorithm & creator data

● RULES & MUST-DO ● HOW IT WORKS ● TRY THIS NOW | MINDSET ● BIG IDEA

How This Works

You don't need to have read anything else. This one page is the whole onramp.

This document takes three separate production bibles — the original Bible, Bible 2.0: The System, and the VanossMethod comedy playbook — and pulls out only the highest-impact stuff. Think of it as the cheat sheet you keep open on a second screen, not something you read cover to cover.

The One Promise

Every idea in here exists to answer one question: **what do I actually do next?** Not "what's the theory behind YouTube" — what's the next concrete action between you and a finished video. If a page doesn't answer that, it got cut.

The Color System

Every box in this document is color-coded so you can scan instead of read. Learn these five colors once:

RED — Rule / Non-Negotiable

BLUE — How Something Works

GREEN — Try This Right Now

YELLOW — Mindset / Watch Out

A purple box means "the single biggest idea on this page" — if you only remember one sentence per section, it's the one in purple.

How It's Organized

PART	WHAT'S IN IT
1 · Foundation	The one rule every top creator agrees on, and how to know an idea is ready
2 · Plan Before You Record	Your 5-minute pre-production system and the 14-day loop that gets videos finished
3 · Packaging	Titles, thumbnails, and the hook — the stuff that actually gets the click
4 · Editing Styles & Cuts	Four distinct editing styles to try, plus a glossary of specific cuts and when to use them
5 · Sound, Tech & Export	Audio levels, export settings, your marker system, your Scimitar mapping
6 · Your Channel Playbook	Your 3 content buckets, Bill's role, and how multi-game channels actually work
7 · The Mindset	Killing perfectionism and what to do on the nights you don't want to edit
8 · 2026 Reality Check	What's verified true right now, with sources — so you're not working off outdated advice

THE BIG IDEA

You are not building videos. You are building a system that produces videos.

Any single video is allowed to be mid. The system is not allowed to stop. Protect the system and the videos take care of themselves — one small improvement at a time. That's the whole game, and it's the last time this document gets philosophical before it starts giving you tools.

The Foundation.

What every top creator quietly agrees on.

Before packaging, before editing, before any of it — there's one rule that decides whether a video has a chance at all. This part is short on purpose. Read it once.

1.1 The one rule every top creator agrees on

Idea → Packaging → Content

1.2 Is your idea actually ready?

The 3-Yes Test

The One Rule

What every framework in this document is secretly built on top of

Idea → Packaging → Content. In that order. Most creators spend 80% of their time on production — recording and editing — and almost nothing on the idea and the packaging. But packaging is what gets the click, and content quality only matters once someone has actually clicked.

STAGE	WHAT IT IS	ROUGHLY	WHAT IT CONTROLS
Idea	The concept, the angle, why this video exists	20%	Everything downstream
Packaging	Title + thumbnail + hook — why someone clicks	30%	CTR (click-through rate)
Content	The gameplay and edit quality itself	50%	AVD (average view duration)

MINDSET · THE BRUTAL MATH

A great video with bad packaging = 0 views. A mediocre video with great packaging = viral potential. This isn't gaming the algorithm — it's respecting that viewers have thousands of videos to choose from. Your packaging is your handshake.

One Sentence Per Expert

CREATOR	THEIR #1 LESSON
Kallaway	Most creators lose in packaging, not production
Paddy Galloway	Write the title and sketch the thumbnail <i>before</i> recording
Aprilynne Alter	Content is the third thing — idea and packaging come first
MrBeast	CTR is your report card — if it's low, fix the packaging
VidIQ	Find what people are already searching for, then make that video

HOW IT WORKS · THE GLANCE TEST (PADDY GALLOWAY)

Can someone understand your thumbnail in under 1 second? Cover the title with your hand and look at the thumbnail alone — is it clear what's happening? If you have to explain it, it failed. One face, one emotion, one visual context.

Is It Actually Ready?

The test that ends idea-paralysis in under a minute

"I'll play Doors" is not a video idea — it's a session. "I'll beat Doors without ever running from an entity" is a video idea. Specificity is what turns a gaming session into something worth filming.

BIG IDEA

"Would I click this if someone else posted it?"

That's the whole test. Answerable in five seconds, by you, right now. A yes doesn't guarantee a hit — it means the idea has earned a recording session. That's all any idea can earn before it exists.

The 3-Yes Test

QUESTION	WHAT A YES LOOKS LIKE
Can I write a title that makes <i>me</i> want to click it?	You feel a small spike of excitement reading it back
Do I know what the thumbnail will roughly show?	You can describe the image in one sentence
Do I know what "the end" looks like?	There's a resolution — win, fail, discovery, or payoff

TRY THIS · CAN'T GET 3 YESES?

Don't abandon the idea — sharpen it. "I'll play Doors" → "I'll play Doors for the first time blind" → "I'll play Doors blind with a 30-minute time limit or I delete the game." Each step gets closer to 3 yeses. Two sharpening passes rescues most "meh" ideas.

Where Ideas Actually Come From

- **Your own streams** — after every stream, ask what the funniest or most surprising moment was. That moment IS the idea.
- **Questions you had going in** — "can you actually beat this without upgrades?" is a title with the packaging already built in.
- **The What If method** — "what if I played this but I could only use one item" — the restriction creates the story.
- **YouTube autocomplete** — type your game into search. Every suggestion is a real search from a real viewer.
- **Your genuine reaction** — if a game made you feel something strongly, that feeling is the premise.

RULE • RETIRE THE KILLER QUESTION

"Why would anyone watch this?" feels like quality control — it's actually a wrecking ball. It has no answer, for anyone, ever (channels with a hundred employees still can't predict what hits). Asking it just filters out *every* idea. Replace it with the click test above and keep moving.

Plan Before **You Record.** The system that actually finishes videos.

Having good taste isn't the hard part — finishing is. This part gives you the 5-minute sheet that makes every recording session aimable, and the 14-day loop that turns "someday" into a real upload schedule.

2.1	The 5-minute pre-production sheet	Package + Premise
2.2	Your 14-day loop, mapped	6 Stations
2.3	Notion HQ & batching	Your Command Center

The 5-Minute Sheet

Everything you fill out before you hit record. Takes one block, timer on.

Step 1 — Pick Your Package (30 sec)

The quick decision tree:

IF...	USE PACKAGE	SAMPLE INTRO LINE
Playing with Bill	Bill Chaos	"Me and Bill are doing this today. One of us is not going to survive. (It's Bill.)"
Clear specific goal	The Mission	"I've been putting this off too long. Today we actually do it."
New game, blind	The Discovery	"I know absolutely nothing about this game. Let's change that."
Could go badly wrong	The Downfall	"This is either going to go perfectly or completely destroy me."
Long grind/progression	The Grind Story	"The goal is simple. The execution is going to be brutal."
Testing something odd	The Experiment	"Here's the question: what happens if... Nobody's tested this."
Failed at this before	The Redemption	"Last time this game beat me. Today I beat it."
Just want to vibe	Commentary Run	"No plan today. Just me, the game, and whatever happens."

Step 2 — Answer 3 Questions (2 min)

Premise

"I'm trying to [do X] in [game]." e.g. "I'm trying to max out Pet Simulator before the event ends."

Promise

"This will either [go perfectly / go terribly / reveal something]." e.g. "We'll finish the fastest run ever, or fail at the last door."

Angle

Solo / With Bill / Challenge run / Discovery / Blind / Competitive — sets the commentary flavor for the whole session.

Intro Line

One or two sentences you'll actually say at the start. Use the template from your package above.

Step 3 — Title Before You Record

RULE · PADDY GALLOWAY'S #1 TIP

Write at least 3 title options and one thumbnail sentence *before* you open the game. If you can't write a clear, compelling title before recording, you don't have a video yet — you have a session. If both feel exciting, record. If they don't, rethink the concept first.

TRY THIS · THE EXCITEMENT TIMER

Give yourself 30–40 minutes total for this whole sheet. When the timer rings, the leading candidate wins — no re-litigating at midnight. A shipped B-idea beats an unshipped A-idea by exactly one video.

Your 14-Day Loop

One video every two weeks. Six stations. Built so nothing is ever rushed, but the heat never dies.

A block is 25–45 minutes with one named objective — "rough cut minutes 0–4," not "edit the video." Blocks are the unit. Days are just the map.

1 • DECIDE

Day 1 · ~1 block

Output: idea locked, 3 titles written, package picked. Run the 5-minute sheet from 2.1.

2 • RECORD

Days 2–3 · ~2 blocks

Output: footage with live markers + a hot-take voice note on your 2–3 best moments right after.

3 • TRIAGE

Day 4 · ~1 block

Output: 4 timestamps marked (Best / Funniest / Tension Peak / Good Intro), title locked. No editing yet — eyes only, blade untouched.

4 • STORY CUT

Days 5–8 · ~4 blocks

Output: an ugly, watchable rough cut. Structure only — polish is banned at this station. Best moment goes first, cut everything that doesn't serve it.

5 • ENERGY

Days 9–10 · ~2 blocks

Output: music, SFX, text, and captions added — as four separate passes, never interleaved. Mix hits target levels.

6 • SHIP

Days 11–12 · ~2 blocks

Output: exported, thumbnail built while it renders, scheduled to your consistent slot. Never "publish when it feels ready."

RESET

Days 13–14 · slack

20-minute ritual: check last video's CTR/AVD, write ONE lesson, bank the next idea, then actually rest. These days are shock absorbers — don't fill them "to get ahead."

BIG IDEA

Why 14 days specifically?

Weekly forces rushing (rushing is where perfectionists spiral). Monthly kills momentum. 14 days gives every video real care AND banks 26 full reps a year — the only thing that actually levels you up. Consistency beats frequency.

MINDSET • WHEN THE LOOP BREAKS

It will — every schedule meets a busy week eventually. Shrink a station, never skip it (a 10-minute Decide still counts). If the loop stretches to 18–20 days, fine — ship it, then start fresh at 14. Two dead weeks? No make-up work. Smallest possible win first, then a half-loop, then back to normal. Skills don't reset.

Notion HQ & Batching

Your production command center, and the filming rhythm that prevents burnout

Your Notion Content HQ

SECTION	WHAT LIVES THERE
Quick Capture	Raw ideas, stream moments — no formatting required, just get it down fast
Brainstorm & Ideas Bank	Developed ideas with title options, game, package type, premise
Stream Planning	Upcoming games, goals, Bill's availability
Video Tracker	Every video: status, upload date, CTR, AVD notes
Production Hub	Active videos, the master template, completed archive

HOW IT WORKS · THE TEMPLATE IS A THINKING TOOL

Fill it out to clarify your thinking, not because it's a cage. If you have a strong idea and know what you're doing, record immediately and backfill the template after. The system serves the video, never the other way around.

Batch Filming & Editing

Film → edit → upload → film → edit creates friction at every step. Batching keeps your brain in one mode at a time.

- ✓ Record 3–4 sessions in one block — your Mon/Wed/Fri/Sat streams are the primary source
- ✓ Flag clips in real time ("clip that") — don't edit during recording, just flag and keep going
- ✓ Process the whole batch in a separate editing session, next day or later
- ✓ Rough cut all videos in one sitting before polishing any single one
- ✓ Schedule 2–3 finished uploads in advance so you're never scrambling the night before

RULE · THE 24-HOUR EXCLUSIVITY RULE

As a Twitch Affiliate, streams get 24 hours of exclusivity on Twitch before any VOD or clip appears on YouTube. This isn't just policy — it also creates real demand: Twitch gets it first, YouTube gets the curated, edited version.

Packaging That Gets the Click.

Titles, thumbnails, and the first 60 seconds — the highest-leverage minutes you'll spend on any video. This part is short, dense, and worth memorizing.

3.1	Title formulas that work for gaming	3 Patterns
3.2	Thumbnails — the 3 C's	Clarity · Curiosity · Contrast
3.3	The hook, 2026 edition	Proof First, Then Breathe

Titles That Work

Under 60 characters. Max curiosity. Three patterns cover almost everything.

Pattern 1 — Negative Frame

Shows things going wrong — sympathy + morbid curiosity. "We Got FIRED From Our Own Store" · "This Game Completely Broke Me"

Pattern 2 — Contrast

Two opposing forces in one title. "I Tried Being Nice in This Game and Immediately Regretted It"

Pattern 3 — Curiosity Tease

A gap between what they know and want to know. "He Should NOT Be Allowed Near A Broom"

Story Lock

Title creates the question, thumbnail answers it emotionally — never the same info twice. That combo guarantees the click.

Title Rules, Fast

- ✓ Under 60 characters — longer gets cut off on mobile, where most views happen
- ✓ The title sells the STORY, the thumbnail sells the GAME and EMOTION
- ✓ Don't repeat the game name in the title if it's already visible in the thumbnail
- ✓ Numbers perform well — "3 Times Bill Almost Ruined Everything"
- ✓ Write 3–5 variations before picking — the first title is rarely the best

HOW IT WORKS · FISH WHERE THE FISH ARE

Before every video, type your game name into YouTube search and note the autocomplete suggestions. Make videos that answer those exact searches — consistent search traffic between uploads, for free.

Thumbnails — The 3 C's

Clarity · Curiosity · Contrast

C1 — Clarity

Understandable in under 1 second. One subject, one emotion, one context. If you have to explain it, it failed.

C2 — Curiosity

Something slightly unexplained enough to trigger a click. Your reaction face + a game element they don't fully understand.

C3 — Contrast

Needs to pop in a wall of competing thumbnails. High contrast backgrounds, bold colors, extreme expressions.

Your Formula

Face + Game Moment + 2-3 Bold Words. Facecam reaction left, game moment right, expression matching the title's energy.

Affinity Photo 2 Workflow

- ✓ Keep a template file with saved text styles — reuse every time
- ✓ Selection Brush to cut yourself out of facecam screenshots cleanly
- ✓ Curves adjustment layer (not brightness/contrast) for a consistent look
- ✓ Test text readability by zooming way out — it has to read at thumbnail size
- ✓ 3 colors max: your face, the game element, the text accent
- ✓ Subtle drop shadow on text so it reads over any background

TRY THIS · CO-OP THUMBNAILS

When Bill's in the video, show both faces — two reaction faces = more emotional information in one image. The title sells the disaster, the thumbnail sells the reaction to it.

The Hook, 2026 Edition

The first 60 seconds decide everything. Here's the current version of the formula.

Kallaway's classic 3-step hook still holds — but 2026 viewer behavior added one wrinkle: **viewers arrive suspicious**. You get about 10 seconds to prove the video is real before you're allowed to slow down.

WINDOW	WHAT HAPPENS
0–15s — Prove It	Dense, fast cuts. Show the premise is real — often your single best moment, teased and cut before the punchline lands.
15–45s — Stakes	What you're trying to do, what failure costs, why today. Context Lean + Pattern Interrupt from the classic formula live here.
45s+ — Breathe	Normal pace returns. Personality gets room. This is where Contrarian Snapback and genuine reactions play out.
Every ~3 min — A Beat	Raise stakes, callback, reveal, tonal shift, or direct address ("okay this is where it gets crazy").

Re-Hook Lines That Work

- "Okay, this is where it actually gets crazy" — raises stakes, signals escalation
- "I didn't expect this to happen" — creates curiosity about what's coming
- "Wait. Hold on." — then pause. One of the most effective retention spikes in gaming content
- "If you've been here from the start, you know why this matters" — rewards loyal viewers

RULE · SHOW YOUR BEST MOMENT EARLY

Don't save your best moment for the end. Put it in the first 30–60 seconds, then tell the story of how you got there. Viewers need proof the payoff is worth staying for — show them early, then earn the rest.

MINDSET · SCRIPT THE HOOK, IMPROVISE THE GAME

The intro is the only scripted sentence in the whole video. Everything after is play. Script your first 30 seconds only — it tightens the video without making it feel produced.

Editing Styles & Cuts to Try.

You don't have to edit every video the same way. This part gives you four distinct editing styles — each mapped to a type of session — plus a glossary of specific cuts and transitions with real examples from your channel.

4.1	Pick your style	4-Style Overview
4.2	Clean + Alive	Your Default
4.3	The Vanoss Bit Method	For Bill Chaos
4.4	The Hero-Clip Arc	For Missions & Grinds
4.5	Quick-Cut Shorts Pacing	For Everything Vertical
4.6	Cut types glossary	The Actual Techniques

Pick Your Style

Four editing approaches, matched to your buckets and packages

Different sessions call for different editing energy. Here's the quick match — details for each style follow on the next four pages.

STYLE	BEST FOR	FEEL
Clean + Alive	Solo horror discovery, simulator grinds, most default videos	Tight cuts, dead air gone, reactions loud and uncut
The Vanoss Bit Method	Bill Chaos, Co-op Disaster, any Bucket 2 session	A playlist of self-contained comedy sketches, not one long story
The Hero-Clip Arc	Mission, Time Limit, Redemption, Grind Story packages	One big arc, best moment first, then earn it
Quick-Cut Shorts Pacing	Every Short, pulled from any bucket	1–3 second hook, one beat, punchline, done

BIG IDEA

These aren't rigid boxes — a co-op session can have a Hero-Clip cold open AND Vanoss-style bits inside it. Think of these as four tools on a belt, not four separate channels. Mix them when the footage tells you to.

MINDSET · WHAT DIED IN 2024–2026

The "effect every 1.5 seconds" overstim style is dead — even MrBeast publicly killed it in March 2024 after his own views went up from slowing down. All four styles below assume restraint: cuts that serve the story, not cuts that fill silence with noise.

Style 1 — Clean + Alive

Your default lane. Use it unless a page ahead tells you otherwise.

"Not too serious, not too polished" isn't lowering the bar — it's the current meta. The 2020–2023 era of an effect every 1.5 seconds is over. The lane that wins now sits between raw/no-edit and overstimulated:

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Clean	Dead air executed on sight. Tight story structure. Cuts serve pacing, not decoration. This is 80% of what "well-edited" means to a viewer.
Alive	Reactions loud and uncut. Commentary that sounds like a person. Energy allowed to breathe between beats.
Seasoned	Effects, zooms, and SFX only on moments that earned them — punctuation, not wallpaper.

Example Timeline — A Horror Discovery Video

WORKED EXAMPLE

0:00–0:15 — Cold tease: your most terrified reaction, cut before the full scare lands. **0:15–0:45** — "I know nothing about this game, let's change that" + what's at stake. **0:45–3:00** — Normal pace exploration, jump scares kept, dead walking/menu time cut. **Every ~3 min** — a re-hook line ("wait, hold on..."). **Final 30s** — the resolution, then cut fast to end screen.

TRY THIS

Watch your last video back and count effects-per-minute. If it's more than 1–2 zooms or stings per minute outside of peak moments, you're seasoning too heavy — pull it back and let reactions carry more of the weight.

Style 2 — The Vanoss Bit Method

Comedy editing for Bill Chaos & co-op disasters. "Film a hangout. Edit a sketch show."

A Vanoss-style video isn't one story — it's a playlist of 6–12 self-contained comedy "bits," each 30 seconds to 3 minutes, each with its own setup → escalation → punchline. The recording session is a sitcom taping; the edit is where the show actually gets made.

The 7-Move Per-Bit Recipe

Print this. Every bit, every time. 5–15 minutes each once practiced.

1. **Find the punchline frame.** Park the playhead on the exact moment the joke lands.
2. **Set the OUT point.** 1–2 seconds after the reaction peaks — cut before it decays.
3. **Walk backward, set the IN point.** The latest moment the joke still makes sense — enter late.
4. **Purge internal downtime.** Cut filler inside the bit — except silence right before the punchline. Protect that.
5. **Missability check.** Could a viewer have missed it? Yes → one recovery tool (slow-mo, zoom, or freeze frame). No → touch nothing.
6. **One sound decision.** SFX hit, OR a music cut to silence, OR nothing. "Nothing" is a real choice.
7. **The full-speed watch.** Play it at 1x. Don't smile? Cut deeper or kill the bit. No sunk-cost mercy.

Example Bit List

BIT NAME	TIMECODE	PUNCHLINE	GRADE
"Bill vs. door"	00:14:20	Door kills him, 8s of silence	A
"Backwards plan"	00:31:05	Plan works, we're more confused than before	B
"The betrayal"	01:02:40	Bill was the traitor all along	A

Target 6–10 usable bits from a 2-hour session. Grade honestly — A = still funny on rewatch, B = smiled, C = "it was funnier live" (cut it).

RULES · THE DON'TS

Don't script jokes (script situations instead). Don't stack effects — one joke, one effect max. Don't explain a joke with text. Don't keep a bit just because recording it was fun — the session laugh nominates it, the rewatch confirms or kills it.

TRY THIS · GIVE BILL AN AUDIO SIGNATURE

Pick one SFX from your library that plays only on peak Bill moments. Use it consistently for 3 videos and it becomes a channel in-joke — the fastest character-building trick that exists.

Style 3 — The Hero-Clip Arc

One big story, built backward from your best moment. Best for Mission, Time Limit, Redemption, and Grind Story packages.

Instead of chronological order, this style is built entirely around a single peak moment — everything else exists to set it up or pay it off.

The Structure

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
CALM	Establish the world and the goal. Let the viewer get oriented.
TENSION	First obstacle or complication. Narrate the stakes out loud.
ESCALATION	Things get harder or weirder. Stay in it — don't bail on the tension.
PEAK	The single most intense/impressive moment. Your red-marked timestamp.
PAYOFF	Win, loss, or surprise. Land it fast — don't drag the ending out.

For anything past ~10 minutes, nest 2–3 smaller versions of this same arc inside the main one — that's what keeps longer videos watchable.

Example Timeline — A Simulator Grind

WORKED EXAMPLE

0:00–0:15 — Tease the moment you finally hit max level. **0:15–1:00** — "The goal is simple. The execution is going to be brutal." **1:00–8:00** — The grind, with 2–3 milestone micro-arcs (small win → new problem → bigger win). **8:00–9:30** — The final push, tension peak. **9:30–10:00** — The payoff in full, then a fast cut to end screen.

MINDSET · IF THE ROUGH CUT FEELS DEAD

Don't reach for polish — polish can't resurrect a structural problem. Restructure instead: move the peak earlier, compress the setup, or re-angle entirely. "The plan falling apart" is often the stronger video anyway.

Style 4 — Quick-Cut Shorts Pacing

A completely different rulebook. Shorts are not miniature long-form videos.

PART	LONG FORM	SHORT FORM
Hook	First 30–60 seconds, builds context	First 1–3 SECONDS — or they swipe
Middle	Multiple beats, full story arc	One beat — the tension or buildup, kept tight
End	Payoff + resolution + call to action	Punchline or reaction — that's it
CTA	Subscribe, comment, watch next	One thing only: "watch the full video" or nothing

RULE · THE PUNCHLINE RULE

End on the reaction, not after it. The moment your reaction to the funny/scary/impressive thing finishes — cut. Don't add five seconds of "anyway subscribe." Anything after the punchline loses views.

2026 Shorts Facts, Verified

- ✓ Max length is 3 minutes (raised from 60 seconds in October 2024)
- ✓ Any vertical or square upload under 3 minutes is automatically classified as a Short
- ✓ Top-performing Shorts still cluster around 20–45 seconds — the longer ceiling is for rare stories that need it, not a new target
- ✓ A huge share of Shorts are watched muted — captions are free retention

TRY THIS · THE SELF-CONTAINED TEST

Watch a clip with sound off — does something visually interesting happen? Now with sound — is there a clear setup, tension, and punchline within 60 seconds? Yes → it's a Short. Needs 30 seconds of context first → it's a teaser, link the full video.

Every long-form video should shed 2–5 Shorts with near-zero extra work — green markers → your Aitum vertical pipeline → captions → ship, uploaded separately from the long-form video, not as a clip of it.

Cut Types Glossary

The actual techniques, what they're for, and a gaming-content example for each

CUT	WHAT IT'S FOR	EXAMPLE ON YOUR CHANNEL
Jump Cut	Removes dead time inside one continuous shot, keeps energy moving	Cutting out the "uhh" between two lines of commentary so it plays as one punchy sentence
J-Cut / L-Cut	Audio from the next (or previous) clip starts before/after the video cuts, smooths transitions	Bill's reaction audio starts a beat before you cut to his facecam — feels natural, not jarring
Match Cut	Cuts between two visually or thematically similar shots to imply connection or time passing	Cut from you loading into the game to your character spawning — skips the boring load screen invisibly
Whip Pan / Whoosh Transition	Fast, energetic scene change; hides a hard cut inside motion	Jumping from "before" footage to "after" a big fail, with a whoosh SFX covering the seam
Freeze Frame	Stops on a single frame to let a reaction or moment land, often with text	Freezing on your shocked face the instant a jump scare hits, before cutting to a re-hook line
Speed Ramp	Slows or speeds footage within a clip to stretch tension or compress boring parts	Slowing down the last 3 seconds before a door opens in a horror game; speeding through repetitive grinding
Reaction Zoom / Punch-In	Pushes in on your face during a genuine reaction — 80% of "edited feel" for 2% of effort	A quick punch-in on your facecam the instant you realize the plan has failed
Silence Cut	Hard-cuts all audio for a beat — the cheapest, funniest effect that exists	Music drops to total silence the second Bill's plan visibly falls apart, before anyone reacts

MINDSET · THE RETIME QUIRK

Speed-ramping a clip in DaVinci only affects embedded audio, not audio on its own track. Standard fix: cut the audio at the ramp point and drop a music hit or SFX over the seam.

BIG IDEA

One effect per joke, maximum. Zoom OR freeze OR SFX OR silence — not all four stacked on the same moment. Stacking effects smothers timing instead of sharpening it.

Sound, Tech & Export.

The numbers you don't want to have to remember mid-edit. One page, bookmark it.

5.1 Audio levels, export settings, markers & shortcuts

The Quick Card

The Quick Reference Card

Audio, export, markers, and your Scimitar mapping — all in one place

Audio Levels for YouTube

ELEMENT	TARGET
Integrated LUFS (whole video)	-14 LUFS — YouTube's normalization target
True Peak Ceiling	-1 dBTP max (one limiter on the master bus)
Voice / Commentary	-12 to -10 dB — always wins the mix
SFX	-12 to -8 dB — matches the moment's energy
Game Audio	-18 to -16 dB — present, never competing
Background Music	-20 to -18 dB — clearly under the voice

Export Settings

SETTING	VALUE
Format / Codec	MP4, H.264
Resolution	1920x1080 (most uploads) or 3840x2160 (4K specials)
Frame Rate	60fps — gaming content should always be 60fps
Data Rate	40,000 kbps for 1080p
Audio	AAC, 320 kbps

Marker Color System (Unified)

RED — Must-use / Best moment

BLUE — Story beat / Setup

GREEN — Shorts candidate

YELLOW — Maybe / Review later

Press **M** while playing to drop a marker without stopping playback. For comedy bits, red = punchline moment, blue = its setup — same colors, same logic.

Corsair Scimitar — Fast Editing Map

BUTTON	ACTION
1	B — Blade tool
2	A — Selection tool
3	Ctrl+B — Split at playhead
4	Backspace — Ripple delete
5	M — Place marker
6	Ctrl+Z — Undo
7	Space — Play/Pause

Set up as a saved iCUE profile for DaVinci Resolve, separate from your gaming profile.

HOW IT WORKS · STAY IN THE EDIT TAB

Unless you need color grading or audio repair, stay in the Edit tab — it covers 95% of a gaming video. Tab-switching breaks flow and slows you down.

Your Channel Playbook.

Your three buckets, Bill's role in them, and why playing lots of different games never has to feel off-brand.

6.1 Your 3 content buckets + the through-line kit

Any Game, One Channel

Buckets, Bill & Multi-Game

Your channel is defined by format and energy, not by any single game

BUCKET	HOOK ANGLE	BEST PACKAGES
1 • Horror & Reactions	Your real reaction IS the content. Play blind, never preview.	Discovery, Redemption
2 • Chaos & Co-op	The disaster writes itself — set up the situation, react genuinely.	Bill Chaos, Downfall, Experiment
3 • Challenges & Grind	Set an impossible-seeming target, don't stop until you hit it.	Grind Story, Mission, Experiment

Any game fits — the angle determines the bucket, not the title. A simulator can be Bucket 3 solo, or Bucket 2 the moment you play it co-op and chaos happens.

Bill's Role

The most watchable co-op content has a clear (unscripted) dynamic. You don't assign roles — you just stay aware of what's naturally happening:

ROLE	WHAT THEY DO	WHY IT WORKS
The Reactor (you)	Responds to chaos, calls out what's happening	Viewers see themselves in this role
The Chaos Agent (Bill)	Makes unpredictable decisions, creates the disaster	Unpredictable = can't look away

The Through-Line Kit (Multi-Game, One Channel)

VidIQ's own 2025–2026 guidance: don't marry a game, chase the audience behind the games. Five constants stay the same no matter what you're playing:

- ✓ **Opening energy** — same intro cadence, package-driven line style
- ✓ **Humor DNA** — your evergreen bits and running callbacks travel with you
- ✓ **Packaging look** — same thumbnail face treatment, colors, title voice
- ✓ **Structure** — calm → tension → peak → payoff is 100% game-agnostic
- ✓ **Recurring cast** — you, Bill, and the roles around you

BIG IDEA

Games rotate. The wrapper doesn't. A subscriber should recognize your thumbnail with the game cropped out — that's the whole trick to a multi-game channel.

The Mindset.

The part that actually determines whether you keep going. Read this on the nights it's hard.

7.1 Killing perfectionism

The B+ Standard

7.2 Emergency cards

For the Hard Nights

Killing Perfectionism

If you don't define "done," perfectionism will define it for you — as "never."

High standards ship the video, read the retention graph, and make the next one better. Perfectionism polishes the same 20 seconds a third time so it never has to find out what the world thinks. One is a quality process. The other is fear wearing a productivity costume.

The B+ Standard — Your Definition of "Done"

Hit all five, the video ships. Not "ships if you feel good about it." Ships.

- ✓ The premise is unmistakable inside 30 seconds
- ✓ Dead air and dead sections are gone
- ✓ Audio is balanced to targets, one full playback confirmed no disasters
- ✓ At least three moments still get a reaction out of you — on your fifteenth viewing
- ✓ Title + thumbnail pass the glance test and tell one story

MINDSET · WHAT B+ DELIBERATELY EXCLUDES

Perfect color on every clip. Invisible-cut smoothness nobody consciously registers. A fourth full rewatch. These aren't quality — they're anxiety with a render queue. Past B+, extra hours buy polish a phone viewer literally cannot perceive, paid for with your next video.

The Addiction Loop — Make the Process Itself the Game

INSTALL	WHAT IT IS
Cue	The project opens itself — template, zero setup
Tiny Start	One block, one named objective, 25–45 min, timer on
Visible Progress	Fill a tracker cell, watch the bar grow
Reward	End every session on your best 20 seconds of the day

TRY THIS · THE QUEST LOG

Before closing Resolve, write one line: the next block's objective. Ninety seconds. This deletes the worst moment in editing — opening the project cold and spending 20 minutes figuring out where you were.

RULE · THE STREAK RULE

One block a day keeps the streak — any block, even 10 minutes. Never miss twice. One missed day is noise. Two in a row is a new habit forming in the wrong direction — the day after a miss, the only job is the smallest possible block.

Emergency Cards

Five ways this actually goes wrong, and the exact move for each

"I DON'T FEEL LIKE IT"

Diagnose in one word: Friction, Fog, Fear, or Tired. Friction → your only job is to open the project. Fog → write the quest line, that counts as the block. Fear → you're not deciding if the video is good tonight, just doing one block. Tired → actually sleep, that's a valid move. Otherwise: 10-minute timer, full permission to stop when it rings.

"THIS VIDEO SUCKS" (MID-EDIT)

You've watched these jokes fifteen times — you're the single most numb human alive to this footage. Ask: does the premise still make sense, and is there one moment you'd genuinely send a friend? Both yes → it's fatigue, keep cutting. Either no → re-angle, don't abandon. No abandoning at Station 4 — ship it or re-angle it.

"I CAN'T PICK AN IDEA"

You're not out of ideas, you're out of decisions. Fifteen-minute timer. Two candidates only. Run the 3-Yes Test on both. One passes → locked, done. Neither passes → sharpen the closer one, twice. When the timer rings, the leading candidate wins, no negotiating.

"IT FLOPPED"

Feel it for one day, that's allowed. Then reclassify as a data point: CTR low + retention fine = packaging problem. CTR fine + early cliff = the first 60 seconds. Both low = concept. Write the ONE lesson. Damage is basically zero — nobody unsubscribed from a channel they haven't found yet.

"I BROKE THE STREAK"

Zero make-up work — there is no debt to pay back. Today: the smallest possible win, one 10-minute block. First loop back = a declared half-loop, one Short shipped in 3 days. Then a normal 14-day loop, no penance pace. Skills don't reset — the counter paused, it never went down.

2026 Reality Check.

Everything in this document double-checked against what's actually happening on YouTube right now — not what worked three years ago. Sources included.

8.1 What's still true, what changed, and the numbers

Verified

Verified as of July 2026

Everything above holds up. Here's the specific evidence, and the two real shifts to know about.

What's Still True

- ✓ Packaging-first (idea → packaging → content) is, if anything, more true in 2026 — the three changes that move the needle fastest according to current creator-strategy sources are still: validate demand before filming, design packaging before content, and engineer the first 30 seconds
- ✓ Pattern interrupts and re-engagement beats every 60–90 seconds remain the standard fix for sagging retention curves
- ✓ The "clean + alive" editing lane (restraint over stimulation) is more validated now than when Bible 2.0 first called it — it's the explicit direction the algorithm rewards
- ✓ Evergreen humor (reactions, running bits, callbacks) still compounds into channel identity; trend-locked jokes still age out in months, not years

What's Different Now

BIG IDEA · SATISFACTION > RAW WATCH TIME

YouTube's Senior Director of Growth & Discovery, Todd Beaupré, has been explicit: the system optimizes for how people *feel* about the time they spent, measured through surveys, shares, and return visits — not just raw watch-time. YouTube has declined changes that would add watch hours if they hurt satisfaction. Translation: a shorter video someone finishes and sends to a friend beats a longer one people merely tolerate.

METRIC	2026 BENCHMARK
CTR (gaming)	8–12%+ is strong; personality-driven channels routinely hit up to 15%
AVD (gaming)	40–50%+ of total video length is healthy
Shorts max length	3 minutes (raised Oct 2024); best performers still cluster 20–45s
Shorts vs. long-form split	Most growing channels run roughly 70/30 Shorts-to-long-form early on, shifting toward 50/50 once established — Shorts for reach, long-form for monetization and trust

HOW IT WORKS · SESSION CONTINUATION

Channels grow fastest when each video naturally leads a viewer to watch another. This is exactly what your bucket system and through-line kit (Part 6) already set you up for — a subscriber who knows what to expect keeps clicking the next one.

Sources

Todd Beaupré (YouTube Senior Director of Growth & Discovery) on satisfaction-weighted recommendations — Creator Insider & Creator Liaison interviews. CTR/AVD benchmarks and Shorts-length data cross-checked via VidIQ, Shopify's YouTube algorithm guide, and multiple 2026 creator-analytics blogs (Hooksnap, Focus Digital, Mediacube). Shorts 3-minute maximum and automatic-Short classification confirmed via YouTube's official Help documentation (effective Oct 15, 2024 / Dec 8, 2025). MrBeast's March 2024 statement on ending "overstim" editing covered by The Washington Post and Tubefilter. Platform mechanics drift — when a claim matters for a real decision, YouTube's official Help pages are always the tiebreaker over any document, including this one.

The Whole System, One Page

Everything above, compressed to what you can screenshot and glance at mid-edit

The 14-Day Loop

- D1 — Decide: 3-yes test, 3 titles, package
- D2-3 — Record: intro line, 3 anchors, live markers
- D4 — Triage: 4 timestamps, lock the title
- D5-8 — Story Cut: peak first, zero polish
- D9-10 — Energy: music → SFX → text → captions
- D11-12 — Ship: one watch, export, schedule
- D13-14 — Reset: one lesson, bank next idea, rest

Editing Style Picker

- Solo horror/grind → Clean + Alive
- Bill Chaos / co-op → Vanoss Bit Method
- Mission / Redemption → Hero-Clip Arc
- Any Short → Quick-Cut Pacing

Emergencies

Don't feel like it	10-min timer, both exits count
Video sucks mid-edit	Re-angle, don't abandon
Can't pick an idea	2 candidates, 15-min timer, leader wins
It flopped	One day to feel it, then it's a data point
Broke the streak	Zero make-up work, smallest win first

The Mix, Memorized

- Voice -12 to -10 dB
- SFX -12 to -8 dB
- Game -18 to -16 dB
- Music -20 to -18 dB
- Whole video -14 LUFS, peak -1 dBTP

Markers

Red = must-use · Blue = story beat · Green = Shorts · Yellow = maybe

Standing Laws

- "Would I click this?" beats "why would anyone watch this?"
- No polish before structure locks
- One effect per joke, max
- Ship or re-angle — never abandon
- One block a day keeps the streak — never miss twice

LAST WORD

The system only works if you actually use it.

Pick one video. Fill in the sheet. Record it. Edit it. Upload it. That first video teaches you more than all of this theory combined. One video at a time. One small improvement at a time. Now go make something.